Signs of food spoilage include difference in appearance from the fresh food such as a change in colour, a change in texture and an unpleasant odour or taste.

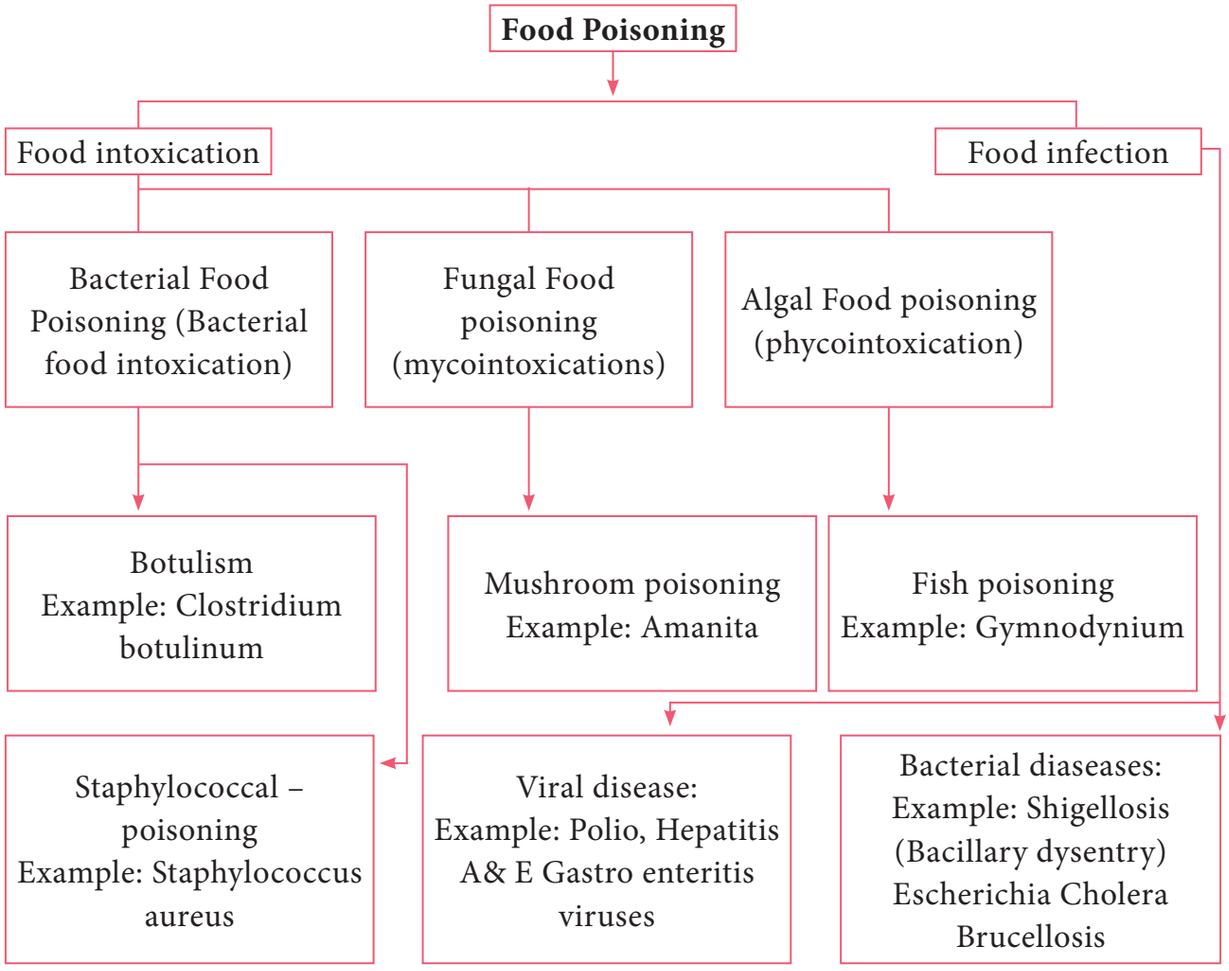
HOTS

1. Why do concentrated citrus juices prevent spoilage problems?
2. Name a few organisms responsible for food spoilage.

5.3 Food Borne Disease

Food borne disease has been defined by the world health organization (WHO) "as a disease of an infectious or toxic nature caused by or thought to be caused by the consumption of food or water. The term "food poisoning" as applied to diseases caused by microorganisms is used very loosely to include both illness caused by the ingestion of toxins elaborated by the organisms and those resulting from infection of the host through the intestinal tract. A further classification of food borne disease is shown in flowchart 5.1.

All these food – borne diseases are associated with poor hygienic practices. Whether by water or food transmission, the fecal – oral route is maintained, with the food providing the vital link between hosts. Fomites, such as sink faucets, drinking cups, and cutting boards, also



Flowchart 5.1: Types of Food – Poisoning

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